2.3.4 Thorax

Thorax or chest is formed by the sternum (breast bone) and costal cartilages in front, ribs at the sides and the 12 dorsal vertebral bones at the back.

The sternum is a flat bone, shaped like a dagger pointing downwards. The tip consists of a cartilage known as the xiphi sternum. The upper part, like the handle is joined to the two collar bones. The costal cartilages are joined to the sides of the sternum and to the true ribs.

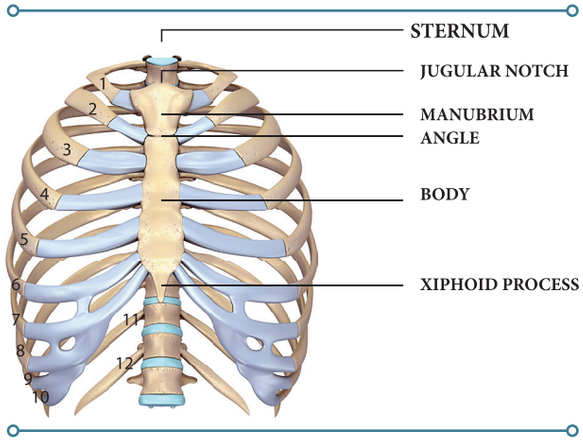
The ribs are twelve pairs of the long curved bones. The upper seven pairs are called true ribs. These are attached to the sternum by its costal cartilages.

The next five parts of the ribs are called false ribs because they are joined their cartilages to those of the ribs above and not directly to the sternum. The last two pars are not connected at all and are called floating ribs.

FUNCTIONS OF THE THORAX

1. Protection for the heart, lungs, liver, stomach, and spleen.
2. Support for the bones of the shoulder girdle and for the breast.
3. Important in respiration.

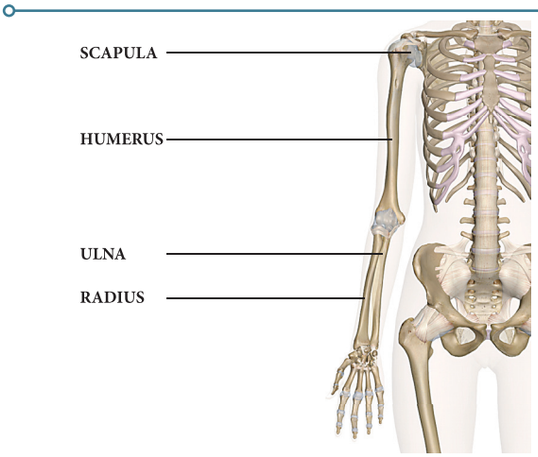
STERNUM AND RIBS

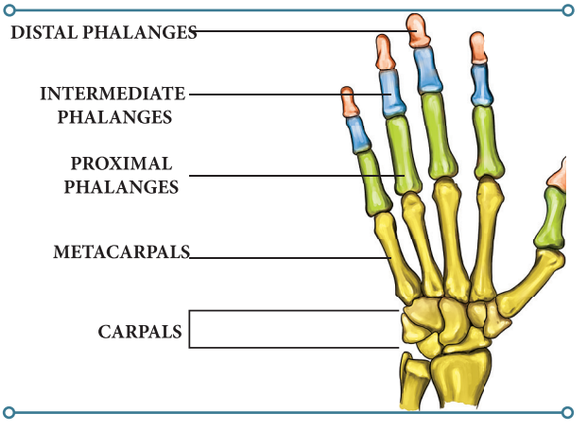


BONES OF THE LIMBS

2.3.5 Bones of the Upper Limb

- Each upper limb consists of thirty bones.
- One collar bone.
- Shoulder girdle.
- One humerus – the bone of the upper arm.
- One radius – the outer bone of the fore arm.
- One ulna – the inner bone of the fore arm.
- Eight carpal bones of the wrist.
- Fourteen phalanges of the fingers.





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